

By Althea Fung

House Minority Whip Steny Hoyer, D.-Md., is pushing for colleges in his district to provide information about health care reform.

In a letter to 14 colleges, Hoyer encouraged the schools to provide more information to students about their health insurance options with information sessions, staff counseling, and pamphlet distribution on campus.

“Before health reform became law, more than one-third of all young adults – including those with insurance – were having trouble paying their medical bills, and one-fourth were paying off medical debt,” Hoyer said in a statement. “It is important that young people understand and have access to the health coverage they need, so I encourage our colleges and universities to help ensure that they are aware of the new options and resources available to them.”

Earlier this year, Health and Human Services Secretary Kathleen Sebelius and Education Secretary Arne Duncan sent letters to colleges and universities throughout the country imploring them to educate students about health care reform.

The Obama administration has offered schools information on how to place a badge on their homepages that links to information about how students can remain on their parents’ health insurance plan; tips on getting sample fliers for students and parents; and information for staffers to give to students about their health care options if their parents aren’t insured.

Young adults stand to benefit greatly from the health care overhaul. Those age 18-26 are the least likely to have health insurance or to see doctors.

Under the health care law, 1 million young adults are expected to join their parents’ policies over the next three years. Approximately 7.2 million are expected to gain coverage through the expansion of Medicaid in 2014 and another 4.9 million could gain coverage through the

insurance exchanges.

According to the Kaiser Family Foundation, at least 637,000 young adults have already obtained medical coverage through their parents' policies since the first quarter of 2011.

*Peer Review Framework for Predictive Analytics
in Humanitarian Response*

MODEL REPORT: Flood Anticipatory Action Trigger in Bangladesh

UN OCHA Centre for Humanitarian Data

June 2023

OCHA CENTRE FOR HUMANITARIAN DATA



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Model Report:

Flood Anticipatory Action Trigger in Bangladesh

1. Background

This report summarizes the documentation and findings of the peer review of the trigger used in UN OCHA's Bangladesh Anticipatory Action framework for floods. The impact prediction model used as a basis for this trigger was developed by the UN OCHA Centre for Humanitarian Data. The go/no-go trigger mechanism is based on the GloFAS river discharge forecasts, combined with water level forecasts by the Bangladesh Flood Forecast and Warning Centre (FFWC). To find out more, please see the [Anticipatory Action Framework for Bangladesh Floods](#).

The review has been conducted between January and June 2023.

2. Main Findings and Recommendations

You can find all the documentation regarding the model, its application and the review process at the following links:

- The [Model Card](#) describes version 1.0 of the model and was completed in January 2023.
- The [Model Evaluation Matrix](#) was completed in March 2023 by Amy Kim, Data Scientist at Betterview, a property intelligence and risk management solution company.
- The [Implementation Plan](#) was completed in March 2023. It summarizes the concrete actions that the model will trigger or inform.
- The [Ethical Matrix](#) aims to identify all stakeholders and potential issues regarding the intended use of the model. The Ethical Matrix was completed in June 2023 by Aarathi Krishnan, Senior Advisor on Strategic Foresight at the UN Development Programme.

A summary of the main findings and recommendations is provided below.

2.1 Technical Review

Intended Use

- The definition of in-scope and out-of-scope use cases is clear, and the output of 1-in-10 year return period riverine flooding is easily interpretable.
- The constraint that flooding will occur only during the monsoon season (June - September) should be reviewed.

Model Development and Documentation

- GloFAS is a widely used, trusted and up-to-date source. In-depth research and skill analysis was performed, and justification was provided for the selection of monitoring stations.
- Household survey used to determine water level threshold needs more documentation.

Model Evaluation

- A benchmarking process should be incorporated to evaluate model performance.
- The peer review process should be completed before model deployment, rather than after.

Operational Readiness

- Readiness has been demonstrated as the model has already been deployed.
- The model and data should be monitored in order to maintain readiness.
- It would be nice for others to be able to run the GitHub repository analysis code.

2.2 Ethical Review

Inaccuracy

The assumption that historical water level is an indicator of impact and river discharge is a good predictor of water level is based on how these metrics have been used historically. It does not take into account how these two assumptions might shift or change based on emerging climate risks that might shift water levels and/or river discharge. If the model cannot account for future risks that might shock linear projections, populations bear the brunt of inaccurate data.

Statistical Bias

While the model draws from global models, it is hard to see how this is validated/contextualized to the specific areas. The implementing agencies are all multilateral excluding Bangladesh Red Crescent Society and therefore there might be a bias in how data is interpreted. Without validation or accuracy of targeted populations, there might be groups that are excluded.

Systemic Bias

Targeted population identification is based on governmental datasets, but no information has been included about how that dataset is designed. There might be a risk of groups being deliberately excluded or specifically privileged. Without validation of potential systemic bias, political bias it is likely that there might be groups deliberately excluded or harmed.

Insufficient Data

As noted above, if there is no data about how future risks might shift, the baseline data set might not represent the current risk levels. This missing data/analysis could lead to incorrect

allocations. It is recommended to consider long term impacts or risks in the next version of the trigger.

Feedback

The Centre invites individuals and organizations working in the humanitarian, academic, research and private sector to engage with us on the peer review process. Please send feedback on the Framework to centrehumdata@un.org.

STATE PROCUREMENT OFFICE TRAVEL PROCEDURES

Effective June 1, 2007, these travel procedures and the applicable form and worksheets shall be used for purposes of Intra-State and Out-of-State travel. Departments may impose additional requirements in its departmental travel procedures.

AIRFARE: Worksheet A

1. Fill in the fields for dates, times, and destination.
2. **Intra-State travel** requires only one airfare quote. See attached Inter-Island Scheduled Passenger & Vehicle Carrier 2007 Quick Reference Guide. Agencies are encouraged to enroll in one or all corporate programs to take advantage of the preferred or fixed-rate fares, minimal or no change fees, and a liberal refund policy.
3. **Out-of-State travel** requires minimum two airfare quotes from two different vendors.
4. For out-of-state travel, select the most economical airfare (unless otherwise justified), based on the itinerary that fits the business needs.
5. The worksheet should reflect the actual flight schedule, including any personal deviations*.
6. The pCard shall only be used for authorized airfare. Any personal deviation costs which increases the airfare is the responsibility of the traveler.
7. Place the total cost of authorized airfare in the appropriate field on the Travel Approval Form (TAF).

*Personal deviation includes personal preferences on air carrier, side trips, routing, etc., and these costs are the responsibility of the traveler. The traveler shall obtain a fare for the authorized portion of the trip and any personal deviation costs.

PER DIEM: Worksheet B

Check appropriate section for intra-state (same day or overnight) or out-of-state travel.

Intra-State Travel

1. Intra-state same day travel requires completion of Section B – Computation of Meal Allowance. If applicable, traveler is entitled to a \$20.00 (or \$24.00 for BU 1) meal allowance.
2. Intra-state overnight travel requires completion of Sections A, and when applicable C or D.
3. Per diem starts 60 minutes prior to the departure time from the traveler's home island and ends upon return to the traveler's point of origin.
4. Calculate per diem based on quarter days (see chart on Worksheet B). Indicate .25, .50, .75, or 1, on the appropriate lines. (Two lines may not be needed, but is available in the event of back-to-back business trips)

For Example: Depart 10/10/07 at 7:00 am Return 10/12/07 arriving at 3:00pm

A. Completion of Per Diem Allowance (Intra-state Overnight)

<u>Dept. Day</u>	<u>Full Days</u>	<u>Return Day</u>	<u>Total Days</u>	<u>Rate</u>	<u>Total</u>
1.00*	1	.75	2.75	90.00	\$247.50

*Per diem starts at 60 minutes prior to departure therefore per diem starts at 6:00 am.

5. When lodging or meals are provided at no charge to the traveler, per diem rates shall be adjusted (reference: HAR §3-10-10 (b)(2)(C) and §3-10-10(b)(4)).

STATE PROCUREMENT OFFICE TRAVEL PROCEDURES

6. Figures in Section D must be entered as a negative number (i.e. dinner –18.)
7. Indicate the total per diem cost on the appropriate line on the TAF.

Out-of-State Travel

1. Out-of-state travel requires completion of Sections A, and when applicable C or D.
2. Per diem starts a minimum 24 hours to the start of business (based on Hawaii Time) and ends when the flight returns to the airport at the traveler's point of origin. It may be necessary to depart the city of origin more than 24 hours prior to start of business in order to arrive at the destination a minimum of 10 hours prior to start of business. In those situations, per diem will be based on the actual departure time.
3. Calculate per diem based on quarter days (see chart on Worksheet B). Indicate .25, .50, .75, or 1, on the appropriate lines. (Two lines may not be needed, but is available in the event of back-to-back business trips)

For Example: Business starts on 9/11/07 at 8:00 am in San Francisco
Business ends on 9/13/07 5:00 pm
Depart 9/10/07 at 7:00 am Honolulu to San Francisco
Return 9/14/07 arriving 3:00 pm back to Honolulu

A. Completion of Per Diem Allowance (Intra-state Overnight)

<u>Dept. Day</u>	<u>Full Days</u>	<u>Return Day</u>	<u>Total Days</u>	<u>Rate</u>	<u>Total</u>
1.00*	3	.75	4.75	145.00	\$688.75

* Per diem starts at 5:00 am (Hawaii time) on 9/10/07.

4. When lodging or meals are provided at no charge to the traveler, per diem rates shall be adjusted (reference: HAR §3-10-10(b)(2)(C) and §3-10-10(b)(4)).
5. Figures in Section D must be entered as a negative number (i.e. dinner –29.)
6. Indicate the total per diem cost on the appropriate line on the TAF.

HOTEL LODGING: Worksheet C

1. **Intra-State and Out-of-State travel** requires a minimum of two quotes nearest the place of business/meeting etc., unless using a conference hotel.
2. Calculate excess lodging for each quotation, including conference hotel.
3. Select the most economical hotel that best fits the business requirements when not using a conference hotel (within the vicinity to the meeting etc.)
4. Prior approval for excess lodging is required for reimbursement, including conference hotels.
5. Place the total excess lodging on the appropriate line on the TAF.
6. The pCard shall not be used for payment of hotel accommodations.
7. Personal credit card information is not mandatory on the worksheet. However, most hotels require this information to guarantee a reservation.

STATE PROCUREMENT OFFICE TRAVEL PROCEDURES

TRANSPORTATION: Worksheet D

1. **Intra-State travel.** Travelers shall use the SPO price list, PL 07-35, for car rental reservations when a rental car is necessary.
2. **Out-of-State travel.** Travelers should use airport and/or hotel shuttles whenever possible. If a car rental is necessary, a minimum of two quotes are required.
3. Car rental shall be used only when no other cost effective means are available.
4. Loss Damage Waiver, or Collision Damage Waiver, or Physical Damage Waiver are the only insurance options permitted and reimbursable by the State for out-of-state travel.
5. If car rental is not required, estimate ground transportation costs i.e. taxi, airport, hotel shuttle, parking, etc.
6. Place the total estimated cost of ground transportation on the appropriate line on the TAF.

FERRY SERVICE: Work Sheet E

1. Agent Number and password are required to obtain a quote on www.hawaiiisuperferry.com/partners/stateofhawaii.
2. On the worksheet fill in the field for dates, times, and location.
3. As a sole source, only one quote is required.
4. Place the total cost of the ferry service (both passenger and vehicle) in the appropriate field on the Travel Approval Form.

Booking Procedures Upon Approval of TAF:

- 1) Reservations for vehicle and all passengers are required.
- 2) Logon to www.hawaiiisuperferry.com/partners/stateofhawaii
- 3) Complete reservation information, including pCard information, and e-mail address.
- 4) The pCard is the only acceptable form of payment and the authorized driver or passenger need not be the pCard holder, and may be used only for authorized travel.
- 5) Receive e-mail booking confirmation, which will include an itinerary, passenger(s) & vehicle information, cost details and payment details.
- 6) E-mail confirmation will include a copy of the boarding passes for the passenger and vehicle.

General Information:

- Ports will be open 2 hours prior to vessel departure. Vehicles should arrive at least one hour prior to departure. Terminal gates will close 30 minutes prior to departure.
- Authorized driver will check-in with boarding pass, driver's license, vehicle registration, proof of insurance, and VMA. Additional passengers will require the boarding pass and a government issued photo identification (i.e. driver's license, state id, or departmental issued id).
- Vehicles are subject to a security and agriculture screening at each port.
- Driver must drive vehicle on and off and remain on board during voyage. All vehicles will disembark from the ferry immediately upon docking.
- Once on board, vehicle must be locked and secured.
- Vehicle with caked on mud will not be permitted on the ferry.
- Drivers and passengers are not permitted on the vehicle deck during voyage.
- Passenger and vehicle tickets are nonrefundable if cancelled within seventy-two (72) hours prior to departure.

Other Miscellaneous Fees

Note and describe on the TAF any miscellaneous expenses such as registration fees.

STATE PROCUREMENT OFFICE TRAVEL PROCEDURES

Travel Approval Form (TAF)

1. Complete the TAF, based on official business dates, times, and using the estimated costs obtained from the worksheets.
2. Attach the completed applicable worksheets to the TAF. *Departments may choose to submit the TAF for approval without the worksheets. Upon return of an approved TAF, the worksheets shall then be completed.*
3. Route the TAF and worksheets to the department's requesting and approving authority as required by departmental procedures.
4. Upon signed approval, traveler can proceed to make travel arrangements.
5. An amended TAF is required only if changes are made to the dates of travel, destination, and purpose of travel.
6. At the time of booking, it may be necessary to make a change in the airfare, airline, or flight itinerary due to lower cost and availability. At such time an amended TAF is not required.
7. Travelers' shall check with departments Administrative Services Office for after-the-fact approvals.

Statement of Completed Travel is required, along with all applicable worksheets and supporting documents/receipts within (10) ten working days upon return to duty for reimbursement of traveler's expenses